

Edit the `/etc/crontab` file to run the poller to generate graphs:

```
* /5 * * * * <cacti_user> php <path_to_cacti>/poller.php > /dev/null 2>&1
```

Optionally, you can install *spine* to get a faster poller engine. Download it from www.cacti.net/spine_download.php and check compilation instructions at www.cacti.net/spine_install.php

Now, open your Web browser and point to the Cacti directory by using the following URL: `http://<address_of_server>/cacti`

Go through the easy two-step installation process and you will come across a login screen. Enter the username and password as admin and admin, respectively. It will prompt you to set a new password for admin to secure your Cacti install.

That's it! Your Cacti installation is ready to serve you.

Let's configure, now

After you log in, the home page provides you with three options: *Create devices*, *Create graphs* and *View*. If you click on *View*, you will notice that there's already a local host device showing a few graphs—Memory Usage, Load Average, Logged In Users and Processes. At this point, you will not be able to see any graphs, as they have not yet been generated. If you take a look after a few minutes, you will notice the graphs, but they will have NaN for all the values. Again, look back in five to 10 minutes, and you will see that the graphs have been filled up with polled statistics.

Now, let us try adding new devices (hosts) and new graphs, and show them on a new graph tree.

The following are the steps to create a new device:

1. Go to *Console* tab on the Cacti Web page.
2. Click on *Create Device* (see Figure 2).
3. Click on *Add* at the top right side of the page.
4. Fill in the fields shown in Figure 3. I've explained the important fields below:
 - 'Description', as the name suggests, is the description of the device. For example, HTTP server.
 - 'Hostname' is the fully-qualified hostname or IP address. For example, foo.bar.com or 192.168.1.1
 - 'Host Template' is for selecting the template matching the host type. This is useful in getting templates while creating graphs.
 - 'SNMP version' is the version of snmp running on the device. Version 3 requires the user name, password and pass phrase created with *net-snmp-config* earlier in the article. Version 1 and 2 only require the 'community' string.
5. Click on the *Create* button at the bottom right corner of the page after you've filled in all the fields.
6. The device has been added now. Scroll to the bottom of the page to see the status of the device (see Figure 4).

Figure 3: The Add device form in Cacti

Figure 4: The newly added device shows up in the status as Success

Figure 5: Link to create a graph for newly created device

Now that you have created a device, you will see a link for 'Create Graphs for this Host' at the top of the page after creating the device (Figure 5). After clicking it, in the *Create* drop-down box under the 'Graph Templates' section (Figure 6), select the type of graph you want to create. Check the required fields in the 'Data Query' section, if any, returned by the SNMP lookup. Now, click on the *Create* button and your graph is ready.

If you want to add more graphs, go to the *Console* tab, click on *Create graphs*. Select the host you want to create a graph for, and follow the above steps to create a graph again.

I'm sure by now you've created a few graphs. At this point, you will notice that only 'localhost' is displayed; the other devices that you added are nowhere around. Since we would like to see them too, here's the way to create a new graph tree:

1. Go to 'Graph Trees' under the 'Management' section listed on the left side pane (Figure 7).
2. Click on *Add* at the top right side of the page.
3. Enter the name of the tree, select the type of sorting, and click on *Create* (Figure 8).